

TURNAROUND

TEXT: 2 Samuel 9:3-7 (NKJV) *"Then the king said, 'Is there not still someone of the house of Saul, to whom I may show the kindness of God?' And Ziba (Zee-baw) said to the king, 'There is still a son of Jonathan who is lame in his feet.' 4 So the king said to him, 'Where is he?' And Ziba (Zee-baw) said to the king, 'Indeed he is in the house of Machir (Maw-keer) the son of Ammiel, in Lo Debar.' 5 Then King David sent and brought him out of the house of Machir (Maw-keer) the son of Ammiel, from Lo Debar. 6 Now when Mephibosheth the son of Jonathan, the son of Saul, had come to David, he fell on his face and prostrated himself. Then David said, 'Mephibosheth?' And he answered, 'Here is your servant!' 7 So David said to him, 'Do not fear, for I will surely show you kindness for Jonathan your father's sake, and will restore to you all the land of*

Saul your grandfather; and you shall eat bread at my table continually.”

INTRO: In this passage of Scripture David is King over Israel. The backdrop for this story involves David making a covenant, many years prior, with Jonathan, who was King Saul’s son.

This covenant came out of a friendship between David and Jonathan, which was solidified with Jonathans loyalty to David when his King father was seeking the life of his friend. Saul wanted to kill David but Jonathan protected him.

In this passage of Scripture Saul and Jonathan are dead and David is King. Even though Jonathan, David’s friend is dead, David remembers and honors the covenant between him and his friend. *Vs. 3 “Is there not still someone of the house of Saul, to whom I may show the kindness of God?”*

Notice here, all David asked was whether or not there was a surviving descendent of Saul with whom he could keep his covenant with Jonathan. Listen to the response of Ziba (Zee-baw), Vs 3 *“There is still a son of Jonathan who is lame in his feet.”* Notice Ziba (Zee-baw) remembers his shame before he remembers his name.

The same is true of everyone in this audience. People will remember our failures...

- He cheated on his wife...
- She was arrested for shoplifting...
- He used to be an alcoholic...
- She had an abortion...

Mephibosheth's problem was that he had been dropped. 2 Samuel 4:4 (NKJV)
“Jonathan, Saul's son, had a son who was lame in his feet. He was five years old when the news about Saul and Jonathan came

from Jezreel; and his nurse took him up and fled. And it happened, as she made haste to flee, that he fell and became lame. His name was Mephibosheth.”

The world is full of people who have been dropped. The church is full of people who have been dropped. There are people in this room that have been dropped. Let's face it, the church has been guilty of dropping a lot of people! (We have the tendency of killing our wounded)

From the time his nurse dropped him Mephibosheth could never shake his history. No matter where he went or what he did his history ruled the day. He couldn't get away from his past. His legs were a constant reminder to him.

There are people in this audience today that would love to escape their past but everywhere they go it seems to arrive before

they do.

Look at this, in one day Mephibosheth went from Prince to Pauper; from fortune to unfortunate; from destined to destitute; from complete to cripple; from capable to incapable!

Have you ever had a thing like this happen to you? One day you feel as if you have the world by the tail on a down hill pull, and the next day all opportunity has evaporated.

Mephibosheth believed his handicap had to do with his legs but in reality, his legs were only a symptom of what was really wrong. His real handicap was that:

HE WAS IN THE WRONG PLACE AT THE WRONG TIME...

The problem here was not as much with the condition of Mephibosheth as it was with his position.

The real problem that Mephibosheth faced was that he was out of place. He was bred and born for a palace, not the ghetto! That is precisely the problem with many of us. We are not in the right place.

We are: (PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Heirs of God...
- Joint Heirs with Jesus...
- A Holy Nation...
- A Royal Priesthood...
- A Chosen Generation...
- A Peculiar People...
- Set Apart for the Work of God...

God commanded Elijah to go to the Brook Cherith and He would sustain him THERE. If Elijah had gone anywhere else, he would have starved to death. He had to be in the right place at the right time! *(Israel: Under the Cloud and Fire... Because of this, A*

Rock followed them)

If we are expecting a turnaround we must position ourselves for a miracle!

All the enemy has to do is keep us out of place! When we are not where we need to be, when we are supposed to be there, we miss out on the provision of God!
(Alignment – Shimmy in my car – Bye bye Shemmei)

Mephibosheth was in the house of Machir (Maw-keer). By all accounts, Machir (Maw-keer) treats Mephibosheth very well, but his resources and ability are very limited.

If you are not in the right place at the right time the thing that blessed you yesterday can keep you from a blessing today. Eventually, Elijah's brook dried up!

It is not difficult to leave those who are your

enemies or who mistreat you, but sometimes you have to leave your friends. Some friends have gone as far as they can go with you but they are not going to the place of your destiny! You have to break out and go it alone if necessary! (Abraham & the servants – *Stay here with the asses - the lad and I are going to worship*) (Old song: “*I have decided to follow Jesus*”... One verse say’s “*Though none go with me, still I will follow*”...)

Machir (Maw-keer) is a place of survival, a land of just enough! God wants to give you a turnaround and bring you into the land of more than enough!

If Mephibosheth could see ahead to the King’s palace, he would have no problem leaving the house of Machir (Maw-keer). The problem is we cannot see everything God has in store for us until we move out by faith.

II. HE WAS BEING NEGATIVELY IMPACTED BY A LACK OF INFORMATION...

David found Mephibosheth living in the city of Lo Debar.

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

The word Lo Debar comes from two Hebrew words and is defined in the following ways:

- Lo - meaning “No”
- Debar - meaning “Word”

When you combine those two words it simply means “*No Word.*” Mephibosheth was living in the land of “*No Word.*”

Mephibosheth knew nothing of: (PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- The Covenant...
- The promise...

- The revelation...
- The blessing...

Just because Mephibosheth didn't know about the covenant did not void it. The covenant was good, valid, and current!

Mephibosheth just needed to get himself into a place of being made aware of, and accepting it by faith. *(Example of people having money being held for them but not being aware of it)*

There are people in this place today who are living a sub-par existence but God has greater things in mind. The reason we are not there is because we have been living in the land of “***No Word!***” I have a word for you, “**GET UP CRIPPLE PRINCE AND MAKE YOUR WAY TOWARD THE PALACE, THERE’S A TURNAROUND COMING!**”

Notice the response of Mephibosheth to all that David told him... 2 Samuel 9:8 (NKJV) ***"Then he bowed himself, and said, "What is your servant, that you should look upon such a dead dog as I?"***

Mephibosheth was not just putting himself down he was speaking against the covenant! When the Syrophenician woman came to Jesus, He told her it was not right to ***"give the children's bread to dogs."*** What Jesus was saying was, you have no place or covenant. This is what Mephibosheth is saying... ***"I have no place, or covenant."***

We must be able to see ourselves within the boundaries of the covenant before we can have a turnaround.

III. HE COULD NOT VISUALIZE HIMSELF BEING BLESSED...

2 Samuel 9:5-7 (NKJV) ***"Then King David sent and brought him out of the house of***

Machir (Maw-keer) the son of Ammiel (Am-mee-el), from Lo Debar. 6 Now when Mephibosheth the son of Jonathan, the son of Saul, had come to David, he fell on his face and prostrated himself Then David said, "Mephibosheth?" And he answered, "Here is your servant!" 7 So David said to him, "Do not fear, for I will surely show you kindness for Jonathan your father's sake, and will restore to you all the land of Saul your grandfather; and you shall eat bread at my table continually."

David went looking for Mephibosheth; Mephibosheth did not go looking for David. You may not have come here today expecting to be brought out of your situation but God is here to bring you into His destiny for you! He always takes the first step; He is the initiator of the covenant. (Jon Ashcraft – The initiator of CT funds – They all have his fingerprints on them – God is about to give you a turnaround and His fingerprints will

be all over the turnaround!)

When Mephibosheth became aware of the covenant and the fact that David was about to bring him out of Lo Debar and the house of Machir (Maw-keer) he humbled himself before the King; he bowed down! No person with a physical defect was supposed to come into the presence of the king.

David bent the rules for Mephibosheth. We may not be qualified to come in... BUT GOD!!!

2 Samuel 9:7 (NKJV) *“I will surely show you kindness for Jonathan your father’s sake...”* As it turns out, this is not about Mephibosheth at all. It was about David’s covenant with Jonathan!

Mephibosheth claims to be a *“A dead dog”* and David never contradicts him. For David, it was not about who Mephibosheth was; it

was about his friend Jonathan!

You may not feel worthy to be brought out of your condition, or to be brought into the promise, which is alright, because none of us are worthy!

Everything we have received is because of Jesus! (PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- God has blessed us for Jesus sake!
 - Our salvation is a result of His blood!
 - Our healing is a result of His stripes!
 - Our peace is a result of His suffering!
 - Our destiny is a result of His victory!
- (Eph. 1&2 “...*God raised Jesus from the dead and set Him at His own right hand, far above... You also hath He quickened...*)

2 Samuel 9:7 (NKJV): (PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- The covenant involved provision! “...I

*will restore to you all the land of Saul
your grandfather...”*

- The covenant involved fellowship with princes and the King! *“...you shall eat bread at my table continually.”*

I can imagine all those who ate at David's table...

- AMNON - Young and strong!
- ABSALOM - The Bible says that from head to toe there was not a blemish on him!
- TAMAR - Historians say perhaps the most beautiful woman of her day!
- ABIATHAR - A loyal priest to David!
- NATHAN - A prophet of God!
- SOLOMON - Wisest man who ever lived!
- DAVID – The greatest King in the history of the world!
- Then, MEPHIBOSHETH!

